

# Two wheels

The idea of bicycles dates back to about 1817, when the German inventor Baron Karl von Drais linked two wheels together on a wooden frame. Drais's bicycle—the “draisine”—had no pedals, and the rider walked along when not freewheeling. People laughingly called it a dandy horse, but the idea caught on.



**Michaux velocipede, 1869**

## Pedal power

- **What?** Velocipede with pedals
- **Who?** Pierre Lallemont and Pierre Michaux
- **Where and when?** France, 1863

The addition of pedals to bicycles led to the “velocipede.” Cyclists pushed on these pedals, making the bicycles as fast as a horse. The velocipede was created in Pierre Michaux's workshop, but the idea may have come from his employee Pierre Lallemont. Riding a velocipede was so bumpy that it was also called a “boneshaker.”

## Electric bicycle (e-bike)

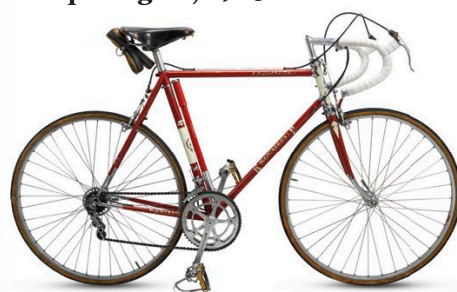
- **What?** Electric bicycle
- **Who?** Hosea Libbey
- **Where and when?** US, 1897

The American inventor Hosea Libbey attached a battery-powered electric motor to a bicycle. However, electric bicycles (e-bikes) only really took off another century later. Today, pedelecs (bicycles in which the rider pedals to help the electric motor) are becoming very popular.



**eZee Sprint, electric bicycle, 2016**

## Campagnolo Gran Sport 10-speed gear, 1963



## Cable-change gears

- **What?** Campagnolo Gran Sport Cambio Corsa
- **Who?** Tullio Campagnolo
- **Where and when?** Italy, 1948

Until the 1940s, racing cyclists who needed to change gear for a hill had to get off the bike and change it by hand. The Italian rider Tullio Campagnolo got so fed up when he lost a race after stopping to change gears in freezing conditions that he invented a cable-operated gear lever system.

## BMX (Bicycle motocross)

- **What?** Schwinn Sting-Ray
- **Who?** Al Fritz
- **Where and when?** US, 1963

In the 1960s, kids got the idea that bicycles weren't just for riding sedately along roads. They could be used for flinging about on dirt tracks like motocross bikes, and doing “wheelies.” It started with the Schwinn Sting-Ray in the mid-1960s, and soon developed into the rugged, fun BMX bicycles.



**Schwinn Sting-Ray Apple Crate, 1973**

WOW!

In 1995, Fred Rompelberg of the Netherlands set a world record with a cycling speed of 166.9 mph (268.83 km/h).